# Closing two schools buys one year. There's a brighter path forward.

D65 has a real money problem. Two schools barely touches it. Better options do.

THE REAL PROBLEM

## D65's costs are growing more than twice as fast as its income.

That gap widens every year. Even after the District's $21 million in cuts, the money still runs out.

WHY CLOSING SCHOOLS DOESN'T FIX IT

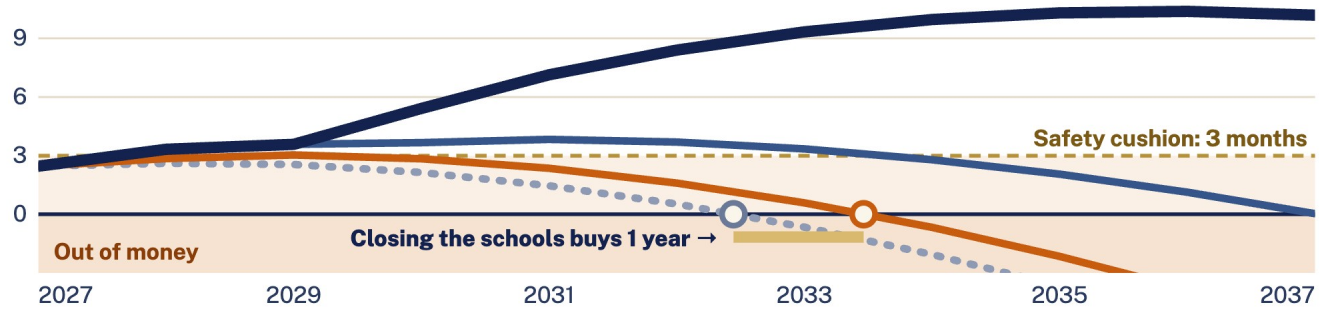
**1%** of the budget, about $2.3M a year

- It pushes the shortfall back about one year.
- Kids still need teachers wherever they go.
- Empty buildings still cost money.

## How long does D65's money last?

Months of savings on hand, by school year

**The District's plan**: close two schools
The District's other cuts, both schools open
**Both schools open**, plus better options
**Better options and a 2028 referendum**




Even before a referendum, the better options stay above the safety cushion for about six years.

BETTER OPTIONS

## Keep both schools and SACC open, and fix the real problem.

- Keep raises comparable to other local districts
- Slow the growth of benefit costs
- Trim central office staff
- Count the savings that come as staff retire
- Sell the empty Bessie Rhodes and Kingsley buildings
- Use taxes coming back from expiring TIF districts
- **Then, a 2028 referendum voters can trust**

Closing Dewey and Lincolnwood
**$2.3M** a year

These options by 2032, roughly
**$16M** a year
plus $9M once from building sales

## Tell the board: vote no on Nov. 16. Then let's build a better plan together.

Check our math: see the full spreadsheet at **forabrighterevanston.org**

Source: D65's budget documents and October 2026 plan, corrected for known errors, in the For a Brighter Evanston model.